



“The downtrend in 2024 was primarily due to global economic uncertainties and inflationary pressures”

PRADEEP AGGARWAL
CHAIRMAN, SIGNATURE GLOBAL

carefully. I hope people in the industry remain conscious and don't chase sales bookings. It is quite a dangerous metric,” he adds.

RATE CUT HOPE

Although overall sales and new launches are sliding, industry experts and developers are harboring hopes of a recovery.

As economic conditions improve, backed by a lowering of lending rates, the real estate industry will return to steady growth in the not-too-distant future, says Signature Global's Aggarwal.

“We are confident of achieving our pre-sales target of ₹10,000 crore and launches worth ₹16,000 crore in FY25. The next year also, we are expecting 20-25% growth in pre-sales, further strengthening our growth trajectory,” he says.

Samantak Das, Chief Economist and head of research and real estate investment trusts for India at JLL, says with two consecutive rate cuts by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI), by 25 basis points each in February and April, the industry is looking at a potential boost to homebuyer sentiment.

“The timing of this rate cut is critical. The market was showing signs of fatigue, with sales in Q1 2025 witnessing a decline. This intervention could be the spark that reignites the flame in the residential real estate sector,” Das says.

Stakeholders in the real-estate industry are pinning their hopes on more rate cuts by the RBI bringing down the cost of home loans, sparking a recovery in consumption and boosting economic growth to help skirt a deeper slowdown this year. **BT**

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CHIEF ECONOMIST AND HEAD OF RESEARCH, JLL

“The person we are worried about and try our best to stay away from is the speculator,” he explained. “That’s because the speculator is the person who overtrades, will take advantage of the installment payment schemes which are available and try to make bookings which at the end of the day cannot be funded unless somebody else can be found to take the property off his hands. That is the person who will suffer in a poor economic cycle,” Singh said.

Singh's concerns are not unfounded. Some buyers resell their allotments at a premium in the secondary market even before tak-

ing possession, increasing the risk of a default if the market sentiment sinks. DLF says 25% of customers who booked homes during recent launches may be speculators who will resell their allotments.

DLF reported bookings worth ₹7,200 crore within 72 hours of the pre-launch phase of its luxury residential development DLF Privana South in Gurugram against 1,113 luxury apartments in late-2023. Overall, it reported bookings worth over \$4 billion (more than ₹37,000 crore) in three years between FY22 and FY24.

“And we watch our receivables very, very closely, and very, very